

IDS11072
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia

Issued at 10:51 pm CST on Thursday 21 May 2026
for the period until midnight CST Sunday 24 May 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A high pressure system over southeastern SA will remain dominant as it slowly moves east and into the Tasman Sea on Friday. A cold front move across across South Australia over the weekend. A low pressure system develops and lingers near the southeast early next week whilst a ridge high pressure builds over the west.

Far West Coast: WA-SA Border to Fowlers Bay

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots offshore. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots turning northerly 15 to 25 knots in the early morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1 to 2 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres inshore, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres offshore. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots shifting southwesterly 15 to 25 knots during the morning. Seas: 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning, then increasing to 1 to 2 metres during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres inshore, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres offshore. Weather: Cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning southerly during the morning. Seas: 1.5 to 2 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Upper West Coast: Fowlers Bay to Elliston

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres south of Streaky Bay. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots turning northerly early in the morning. Winds reaching up to 25 knots south of Streaky Bay in the late morning and early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots shifting west to southwesterly in the evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the late afternoon and evening.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning southerly during the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Lower West Coast: Elliston to Cape Carnot

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly 15 to 20 knots before dawn. Winds reaching up to 25 knots offshore in the early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots tending northwest to southwesterly in the late evening. Seas: 1 to 2 metres, decreasing below 1.5 metres by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm offshore in the evening.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: West to southwesterly 15 to 20 knots tending south to southwesterly during the morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly 15 to 20 knots in the early morning. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres in the west around midday. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1 to 2 metres in the west. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots shifting south to southwesterly during the morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

South Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly early in the morning. Winds reaching up to 20 knots west of Kangaroo Island in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres west of Kangaroo Island. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots shifting south to southwesterly during the day. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers.

Upper South East Coast: Murray Mouth to Cape Jaffa

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots offshore in the late morning and early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots shifting south to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres inshore, increasing to 2 to 3 metres offshore during the evening. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Lower South East Coast: Cape Jaffa to SA-VIC Border

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres, decreasing to 2 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots shifting south to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres inshore, increasing to 2 to 3 metres offshore. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly in the early morning. Winds reaching up to 20 knots south of Port Neill to Port Victoria in the early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Becoming cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Port Neill to Port Victoria. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: North to northwesterly 10 to 15 knots shifting south to southwesterly during the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo during the evening. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Becoming cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots shifting south to southwesterly during the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Becoming cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly early in the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots shifting south to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres inshore. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 3:40 am CST Friday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.
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